

Emploid Philosophy & Overview

1. Introduction & Origin

Emploid is a job-search web application designed and built by a team of five students at the Carlson School of Management (under project code IBUS 3055). Unlike traditional corporate job portals, Emploid is positioned as a consumer-advocacy tool for job seekers. It acts as an aggregator and verification engine, rather than a middleman or sponsored job board.

2. The Problem: "Ghost Jobs" & Stagnant Listings

The modern online job search is plagued by inefficiencies, dark patterns, and deceptive practices. A key issue targeted by Emploid is the prevalence of **ghost jobs**listings that remain online indefinitely despite the employer having no active intent to hire.

- **Evergreen postings:** Companies keep listings active to build resumes databases, boost brand visibility, or project growth to investors.
- **Stale posts:** Automated scrapers replicate old listings across multiple platforms (Indeed, LinkedIn, Glassdoor) long after a role is filled.
- **Pay-to-boost:** Job boards monetize by allowing companies to pay to keep listings at the top of search results, obfuscating how old or active a posting actually is.
- **Data harvesting:** Middlemen sites aggregate listings to harvest applicant contact data and sell resume packages, routing candidates through extensive form funnels rather than directly to the employer.

These factors result in applicants spending hours tailoring resumes and cover letters for roles that are functionally closed, leading to search fatigue and low reply momentum.

3. The Emploid Solution

Emploid solves this by prioritizing transparency and direct connection above all else. It is founded on three core pillars: 1. **Aggregated Coverage:** Scrapes and indexes listings from 6+ major job boards (including LinkedIn, Indeed, Handshake, Glassdoor, and direct company careers sites) to provide a single, unified view. 2. **Proprietary Listing Trust Score:** Computes a score (0 to 100) for every single listing, estimating the probability that the job is active and authentic. Low-trust listings are flagged or filtered out. 3. **No Middlemen (Direct-to-Employer):** Emploid has no "Easy Apply" equivalent that holds resumes hostaged. Every single application button routes the candidate directly to the employer's Applicant Tracking System (ATS) or official careers page. 4. **No Sponsored Boosts:** Emploid does not accept payments from companies to boost their jobs in the search rankings. Ranking is purely based on relevance, transparency, and listing trust.

4. Product Surfaces

Emploid is structured as a responsive Single Page Application (SPA) with four primary user-facing areas:

- **Search (Home):** Features a massive newspaper-style hero section, a search input for titles/locations, a live preview of trust-scored listings, a visual "How it works" section, and a side-by-side comparison of Emploid vs. typical job boards.
- **Browse Jobs:** A two-column interface. The left column contains filters (Trust Score minimum, salary range, hiring activity, remote vs. hybrid vs. onsite, job type). The right column shows active job cards, opening into a high-fidelity detail modal containing description metadata, recruiter contact cards (if identified), and a breakdown of the trust score.
- **Application Tracker:** A dedicated workspace where job seekers can track their submitted applications. Includes a status-stage slider (Saved, Applied, Interview, Offer, Rejected) and a visual "Weekly Reply Momentum" chart.
- **About Page:** Recounts the origin story of the Carlson School student team, explaining why they built Emploid, and lists team bio cards.

5. Copywriting Voice & Tone

Emploid communicates with a very specific, carefully crafted brand voice. To ensure content aligns with Emploid's guidelines, the AI must adhere to the following rules:

- **The Persona:** A "frustrated insider." The copy writes like an industry veteran who has seen through the job board games and is giving the candidate plain, unfiltered advice. Confident, direct, and slightly cynical but never preachy.
- **Pronouns:** Writes in the second-person ("you") to address the job seeker, and first-person plural ("we") when referring to the Emploid team/product. Avoids corporate third-person speak.
- ***Correct:*** "You end up spending hours crafting cover letters for roles that were never truly open. We built Emploid to fix this."
- ***Incorrect:*** "Emploid provides job seekers with optimized matching, allowing users to apply through our partners."
- **Vocabulary:** Uses direct, crisp language. Uses the industry term "ghost jobs" in straight double quotes (e.g. "ghost jobs") when introducing it to emphasize that it is industry jargon.
- **Casing:**
 - Headings (H1, H2) use **sentence case** (e.g., "Find jobs that are actually hiring.") rather than Title Case.
 - Proper product names use **Title Case** (e.g., *Listing Trust Score*, *Application Tracker*, *Direct Company Link*, *High Trust*, *Review Carefully*).
 - Section kickers/eyebrows use **ALL CAPS** with letter-spacing (e.g., `THE TEAM`, `HOW IT ACTUALLY WORKS`).
- **Emoji Policy:** Under no circumstances should any emojis be used in the UI, button labels, or copywriting copy.
- **Numbers:** Always favors concrete figures over vague words (e.g. "12,000+ listings scanned" instead of "many listings"). Formatting thousands with commas.